onwards. Art argued that China pursued hard balancing against the United States in this period but that it was part of a mixed behaviour, combining balancing with close economic cooperation.[7] This works, if we apply the wider definition of hard balancing. Goldstein, on the other hand, has called China's policy towards the United States during this period a "strategy of transition," because he found it to be in between balancing and bandwagoning and with an anticipation that the strategy would change as China closed the gap.[8]

India's policy today is well described by Mukherjee in this volume, referring to India's engagement with Japan as a strategy of long-term balancing and gradual build-up of economic power that can be simultaneously channelled into military power against a potential threat from an adversary. Even though India in recent years has gradually taken a more conflictive approach and is responding to a potential threat from China in several theatres, India's policy on China is still one of mixed behaviour, although moving towards more confrontation.

India is well aware of the risks associated with both balancing and bandwagoning.[9] Bandwagoning involves risks of losing autonomy because of the stronger states' political domination. Hard internal balancing involves a risk of a misdistribution of internal resources that may destabilise the domestic social infrastructure, and external balancing involves risks of entrapment and abandonment. For the time being, despite moving towards more confrontation, India is still hedging China's rise and through this gains the benefit of buying time. We will now turn to how India over the next years might change the way it manages China.

The future